

[Required] Please enter what you learned from today's lecture in at least 30 words.

I learned that data science combines data and scientific methods to tackle real-world business challenges. It was eye-opening to hear that data analysts spend 80 to 90 percent of their time just cleaning up messy data before doing any actual analysis. I also learned how crucial it is to define a solid hypothesis and focus on actionable insights rather than just looking at random numbers. Finally, I got a good grasp of the course logistics, like using omniscampus for assignments and how the grading system works.

(Optional) Please provide specific details about what you particularly liked about today's lecture.

I really loved the practical, real-world focus of the lecture! Shuai's opening joke about the trolley problem was a hilarious way to break the ice, but what I found most inspiring was hearing about his personal journey. Seeing how he started right where we are in GCI and went on to found his own startup, Bakutan, reaching \$1 million in operating profit, made the possibilities feel incredibly tangible. I also really appreciated how modern the teaching approach is. Finally, Aki's explanation of the hybrid sessions and the potential for the Matsuo Lab team to actually visit our university for a hackathon was a huge surprise and makes me super motivated to keep my retention rate up!

(Optional) If there were any parts that were unclear or areas for improvement, please provide specific details.

The difference between the "Honors" and "Outstanding" student criteria was a little bit confusing initially, but the slides broke it down nicely. It would be awesome if we could get the homework deadlines synced to a calendar for easier tracking, since I know we don't have that yet.

Regarding the instructor, please provide specific details about what you liked or disliked.

I really enjoyed Shuai's energy and hearing about his own journey starting a business through the Matsuo Lab ecosystem. Aki also did a fantastic job handling the massive Q&A session; he was super patient even though there were nearly 1,200 questions to sift through.

(Optional) Please write down any lectures or fields you would like to attend in the future.

I'm really looking forward to week two, where we dive straight into Python, since I know it's basically the core language of AI. I also can't wait to learn how to build predictive models and use Generative AI tools to help me get "unstuck" while coding.

(Optional) Please feel free to write any other comments or opinions.

I'm super excited to start this journey and get my hands dirty with the Kaggle style competitions later on. It's also awesome that the course actually encourages us to use AI tools to support our learning process. Thanks to the whole GCI team for making this available globally!